

‘The political fallout really depends on who Bostonians blame for it.’

ERIN O'BRIEN, *UMass Boston political science professor*

Wu’s defeat could put her on defensive

Tensions high with Senate, business leaders

By Anjali Huynh and Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

An unabashed progressive with a fierce focus on making the city affordable, Boston Mayor Michelle Wu has for years sparred with the real estate industry, from promoting rent control back during her 2021 mayoral campaign, to funding affordable housing by taxing high-dollar real estate transactions.

Yet none of her skirmishes

with the powerful real estate lobby required the political capital she spent on her months-long fight to shift more of the city’s tax burden onto commercial real estate to soften property tax increases on residents. After several procedural delays, Wu this week suffered a resounding defeat when leaders in the Senate declared the proposal dead.

Wu negotiated with major business leaders for months at the behest of the Senate president, who lives in Ashland. But when the deal they struck finally reached the Senate, her fragile coalition crumbled after new city projections showed

WU, Page A10

In Pa., shooting suspect fights extradition to N.Y.



JEFF SWENSEN/GETTY IMAGES

Luigi Nicholas Mangione struggled and shouted while being led into court on Tuesday in Hollidaysburg, Pa.

Reportedly criticized ‘parasitic’ insurance companies in document

By Michael R. Sisak and Mark Scoloro
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ALTOONA, Pa. — The man accused of killing UnitedHealthcare’s CEO struggled with deputies and shouted while being led into court Tuesday as new details emerged about his possible motivation behind the ambush.

In his first public words since a five-day search ended with his arrest at a McDonald’s in Pennsylvania, Luigi Nicholas Mangione emerged from a patrol car shouting about an “insult to the intelligence of the American people” while deputies pushed

him inside a courthouse.

The 26-year-old Ivy League graduate from a prominent Maryland real estate family is fighting attempts to extradite him to New York so that he can face a murder charge in the Manhattan killing of Brian Thompson, who led the United States’ largest medical insurance company.

A law enforcement bulletin said that at the time of his arrest, Mangione was carrying a handwritten document expressing anger with what he called “parasitic” health insurance companies.

SUSPECT, Page A5



ERIC THAYER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

THOUSANDS FORCED TO FLEE CALIF. WILDFIRE

The wind-driven blaze in Malibu raged near Pepperdine University (left) on Tuesday and the school moved students from their dorms to the library because of the conditions. “It felt super apocalyptic,” one student said. The university later said the worst of the fire had pushed past the school after singeing parts of the campus. Many celebrities who live in Malibu, among them 98-year-old Dick Van Dyke, evacuated. It was not known how the blaze, named the Franklin Fire, started. A2.

Musk’s vision of cuts has a familiar ring

Despite the hype, it’s an old D.C. story

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It has all the hallmarks of a buzzy initiative from the world’s richest man: sky-high goals, an almost impossibly ambitious timeline, intense media interest, and liberal use of internet memes.

But in launching a “Department of Government Efficiency,” Elon Musk is not so much breaking new ground as he is dusting off a longtime, occasionally executed ritual of Washington governance.

After winning the election, President-elect Donald Trump

quickly empowered Musk, his most important benefactor, to undertake a project to massively slash the size and scope of the federal government.

Any enterprise headed by the Tesla and SpaceX multibillionaire — who also happens to be a right-wing influencer and media magnate — was bound to attract intense enthusiasm from admiring lawmakers and interest from the public.

Musk’s visit last Thursday to Capitol Hill, along with his co-chair, former GOP presidential candidate Vivek Ramaswamy,

DOGE, Page A6

Countries targeted in 2017 with Muslim-majority population

North Korea and Venezuela were soon added to the list. Some immigration experts fear a new ban may include more countries and could affect US citizens and permanent residents in unexpected ways.



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Possible new travel ban has Muslims bracing

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — In January 2017, Massachusetts immigration lawyer Mahsa Khanbabei was caught by surprise when then-president Donald Trump issued an executive order that restricted travel from certain predominantly Muslim countries.

Described as a “Muslim ban” by Trump’s aides as well as his critics, it sparked protests nationwide and disruption and chaos in airports across the country. Khanbabei said she remembers rushing to Logan Airport with colleagues, trying to help people whose family members were denied

entry.

“No one had ever anticipated that a president would try to just blatantly discriminate against a whole group of people because of their religion,” she said.

The restrictions, which had been modified to include non-Muslim-dominated nations, were removed by President Biden as soon as he was inaugurated on Jan. 20, 2021. But with Trump returning to the White House in 2025, many Muslims in New England are bracing for the possible reinstatement of the ban, as well as other actions against immigrants in the United States. Lawyers, mosques, MUSLIMS, Page A7

Israel takes out Syrian weapons

Seeing an opportunity in regime change, it launched hundreds of airstrikes to keep the arms out of the hands of extremists. A3.

A holiday display in Concord, N.H., installed by The Satanic Temple was vandalized shortly after it went up. B1.

Making a group meal can seem impossible with so many people with so many restrictions. But there are some things you can do. G1.

Pour taste

Wednesday: Rain, wind. High 62-67. Low 36-41.

Thursday: Sunny, breezy. High 42-47. Low 24-29.

High tide: 6:59 a.m., 7:32 p.m. Sunrise: 7:03 Sunset: 4:12

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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Hamilton O'Rourke, 10, took his asthma medication, which has changed.

Issue with drug’s cost harms kids with asthma

Generic substitute pricier than canceled inhaler

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts families are still struggling to find alternatives about a year after GlaxoSmithKline canceled a widely prescribed children’s asthma medication, a problem given renewed urgency as flu and respiratory virus season sets in.

Flovent HFA, GSK’s brand name for its discontinued inhaler, hasn’t been available since December 2023

when, in response to new federal price limits, the company introduced an essentially identical authorized generic version. The company stated the move was done to keep an important drug available, “potentially at a lower cost.”

But, perversely, the generic is generally more expensive and now fewer insurers are covering the replacement. Meanwhile, alternatives that are appropriate for children are hard

to find, families and their doctors say. Moreover, physicians worry that when insurers revamp their lists of covered medications for the coming year, families will have to go through the challenging process of finding an appropriate replacement all over again.

“January 1, those formulary lists are going to change again, and we don’t know what’s on them,” said Dr. Robyn Cohen, associate medical director of asthma initiatives at Boston

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